

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at BYREDO,

I trained and practised as an architect, and the part of the work that has held my attention most consistently is the technical resolution of a building rather than its first image, meaning how it is put together, what it is made of, and what those choices cost over the building's life. That interest is what took me to a Master's Degree in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy, where I worked on computational geometry, new material systems and the environmental performance of construction. The Architect seat at BYREDO runs across that whole range, from stores and shop-in-shops to furniture, displays and installations, where a brief has to end up standing in a space.

At Isay Weinfeld Architects, working on large residential, hotel and mixed-use buildings, I sat across both the design team and the technical development team, which meant that facades came to me at the compositional stage and stayed with me into the build-up. That work ran from what the envelope should be to how it would be made, through material selection, fixing and jointing detail, preliminary structural sizing, and a continuous conversation with the structural and services engineers whose input I reviewed against the design intent before it was documented. Handling a facade end to end that way taught me that an envelope holds together only when its appearance, its build-up and its performance are settled in the same decisions rather than passed between people in sequence. Taking a store concept from a brief through to fixtures, finishes and production drawings is that same movement, at a scale read from arm's length rather than across a street.

Material research was at the centre of my master's work at The Royal Danish Academy. I developed a construction technique using blue biomass, seashells and algae bound into a rammed composite, running LCA metrics alongside parametric simulation so that structural performance and environmental impact were pushed in the same iteration rather than traded off afterwards. That work became the material basis for the school's installation at the Venice Architecture Biennale 2025, where I produced the physical panels shown in the seven-metre structure built at the Arsenale with CITA, GXN and 3XN. What the period taught me is that a new material only becomes an engineering proposition once someone has taken it far enough that it has to be built and has to stand up. Retail interiors are where a material is looked at most closely, so what one can be made to do belongs inside the concept.

My portfolio, with the built work and the drawings and visualisations behind it, is at antoniocarmagnani.com. BYREDO treats its spaces with the attention it gives its products, which makes the architecture team's work part of the brand rather than a setting for it. That is where I want to keep working, on spaces and objects whose quality is carried by how they are detailed and made, not only by how they are drawn.

Best,

Antonio Carmagnani